Babur's rebel minister Sulṭān Ahmed Tambol had held Babur's brothers Jahangir Mīrzā II and Nasir Mīrzā as hostages. In AD 1501, Babur had lost Andijān and Ferghana to him. Not only this, but Babur had also lost Samarkand to Muhammad Shaybāni Khān. The situation was devastating. He was without a kingdom, without a home. He had to take his family to Tashkent under the protection of his maternal uncle, Sulṭān Mahmud Khān, the Chagatai Khān of Western Mūghalistan. He served as an officer in Khān's army without holding any authority over any territory. The tide of Uzbeks under Muhammad Shaybāni was rising heavily. Sulṭān Mahmud Khān allying with his brother Ahmad Alaq in Uyghurstan decided to join forces to stem the growth of the Uzbek power in the west from reaching their borders by invading Central Asia. Babur too was looking at the opportunity to be part of this operation as he was looking for a chance to regain his lost territories.

Sulṭān Mahmud Khān left for Andijān, leaving his son Sulṭān Muhammad in Tashkent with a strong army. He left Uratippa in the hands of Mīrzā Muhammad Hussain Dughlat. He always feared that Uzbeks from rear while he would be conducting operations against Sulṭān Ahmed Tambol in Andijān, and hence he left two major armies behind. He was convinced that Muhammad Shaybāni Khān wouldn't cross those armies. Sulṭān Mahmud Khān marched into the former Tīmūrid territory with the remainder of his army of 15,000 men along with Babur.

But the things were not set to happen as Sulṭān Mahmud had thought. Muhammad Shaybāni Khān received intelligence of the Mūghals' movement. Without any delay he hastened with an army of 30,000 men from Samarkand to Ferghana, passing by Uratippa on his road. The reluctant Mīrzā Muhammad Hussain Dughlat was expecting Uzbeks to besiege him; hence he had all preparations done at the fort. Muhammad Shaybāni had bigger and more thoughtful plans. He arrived in the afternoon itself and encamped close to the town. Beyond anyone's expectations, he broke up his camp and marched towards Ferghana with his fleet at the quickest he could. When inquiry was made, he was already miles away. Several messengers were dispatched to notify the Khāns in the concerned locality. But both messengers and the fleet of Shaybāni reached at the same time. Unfortunately, neither the army of Tashkent nor of Uratippa could come to aid the Khāns.

The Khāns were far far away from Andijān. Akhsi (possibly a town; a few miles away from Namangan), the town with the strongest forts in that country, was occupied by Shaikh Bayazid, brother of Tambol. Muhammad Shaybāni Khān came up with 30,000 men. The Khāns had hardly enough time to draw up in line, when, after a short conflict, the Khāns were put to rout by the overpowering numbers of the enemy. Their horses being rendered useless with fatigue, the two Khāns were taken prisoner. As for Babur, he fled to the hills to the south of Ferghana.[13]

Khunjad was another town in Ferghana. It was located almost in the centre of Andijān and Samarkand, ranging west and east respectively. Khujand was one of the most ancient towns of the locality. Shaikh Maslahat and Khwaja Kamal belonged to this place.

This place too was known for its fruits. Babur says that the pomegranates of Khujand were as famous as the apples of Samarkand. Something quite